

Year 4 Grammar - Direct and Reported Speech

Name: _____ Date: _____

ACARA v9.0 Alignment: AC9E4LA07 - investigate how quoted and reported speech work in different kinds of texts.

Learning Intention

I can recognise direct speech and reported speech, and use them clearly in sentences.

Grammar Strategy

Direct speech uses the speaker's exact words. Reported speech tells what someone said without using the exact words.

Vocabulary Helper

direct speech - the exact words a person says

reported speech - telling what someone said in your own words

quotation marks - punctuation around exact spoken words

Worked Example

Direct: "Please close the gate," said Noah. Reported: Noah asked someone to close the gate.

Success Checklist

- ☐ I can name the grammar feature.
- ☐ I can use it in my own sentence.
- ☐ I can explain how it helps the reader.

Mini Practice

Change to reported: "I found the map," said Zara.

Add quotation marks: I am ready said Liam.

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Warm Up

1. Circle the direct speech: "Look at the rainbow," said Ava.

2. Tick reported speech: Mia said she was tired. / "I am tired," said Mia.

Build Your Skills

1. Add punctuation: I need help said Harper.

2. Change to reported speech: "The bus is late," said Ethan.

3. Write one direct speech sentence and one reported speech sentence.

Strong Challenge

Write a short dialogue between two characters, then rewrite one line as reported speech.

High Five!

You used grammar tools to make writing clearer. That is strong author thinking!

I Can Checklist

☐ I tried each section.

☐ I checked my sentence.

Teacher Feedback

What went well: _____

Next step: _____

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Answer Key and teaching support

Answer Key

1. "Look at the rainbow,"; Mia said she was tired.
2. "I need help," said Harper.; Ethan said the bus was late.
3. Check punctuation and meaning.

Parent Tip - At Home

At dinner, say a funny sentence. Ask your child to report it: "Dad said the peas were escaping."

Teacher Tip - In Class

Model speech punctuation with a speech bubble first, then convert the bubble to a sentence.

Mini Rubric

Look for: correct grammar feature, clear meaning, careful punctuation and a sentence that makes sense to the reader.